भारत सरकार/Government of India
वित्त मंत्रालय /Ministry of Finance
कार्यालय/Office of
मुख्य सीमाशुल्क आयुक्त
THE CHIEF COMMISSIONER OF CUSTOMS
मुंबई अंचल - III /MUMBAI ZONE III
छत्रपति शिवाजी महाराज अंतर्राष्ट्रीयहवाई अड्डा,
मुंबई-400099
CSM International Airport, Mumbai-400099

भारत
सरकार

F. No. S/V-30(06)/CCO-III/T-I/2019-20 Pt. I Date: .03.2022

Minutes of the Customs Clearance Facilitation Committee (CCFC) Meeting held on 22.02.2023

Meeting of the Customs Clearance Facilitation Committee (CCFC) was held on 22.02.2023 at 1500 hrs. in the Conference Room, Air Cargo Complex, Sahar, Mumbai, which was chaired by Shri Roopam Kapoor, Chief Commissioner of Customs, Mumbai Zone-III.

2. Following representatives of the Partner Government Agencies (PGAs) and that of other stakeholders were present in the meeting:

Sr. No.	Name of the Representative (Shri/Smt/Ms.)	Name of the Organization
1.	Dushyant Mulani	Brihanmumbai Customs Broker Association (BCBA)
2.	Sanjeev Harale	BCBA
3.	Ketan Desai	BCBA
4.	Paresh Sangrani	BCBA
5.	Mrs. Manita Churi	Technical Officer,A.D.C
6.	Mohamed Nasir	MIAL
7.	Makrand Patkar	MIAL
8.	Satish Prasad Tiwari	MIAL
9.	Vijay Ghadigaonkar	Air India Ltd.
10.	Kamlesh C. Sawant	Air India Airport Services Ltd.
11.	Balchandra B. Bansode	Air India Airport Services Ltd.
12.	Vivek Salunke	Air India Airport Services Ltd.
13.	Kishore V. Torvi	Textile Committee
14.	Mohd. Baqir Agha	MIAL

No representative from other PGAs like ADC, FSSAI, Postal Department.

The Customs Department was represented by the following officers:

Sr. No.	Name (Shri/Smt/Ms.)	Designation	Commissionerate
1.	Ranjit Kumar	Commissioner	ACC (General) & (Export)
2.	Manish Mani Tiwari	Commissioner	CSMI Airport& APSC
3.	G. Shiril Saroj	Commissioner	Import
4.	Pawan Kumar Khetan	Addl. Commissioner	ACC(Export), MZ-III
5.	Vinay Kumar Arya	Addl. Commissioner	ACC(Import), MZ-III
6.	Rajiv Shankar	Addl. Commissioner	CCO, MZ-III
7.	Tapan Kumar	Addl. Commissioner	ACC(Import), MZ-III

Sr. No.	Name (Shri/Smt/Ms.)	Designation	Commissionerate
8.	G. Manigandasamy	Addl. Commissioner	ACC (General), MZ-III
9.	Ms. Nancy D'souza	Joint Commissioner	ACC(Import), MZ-III
10.	Satish V. Shitole	JC(In-situ)	ACC(Import), MZ-III
11.	Vivek Anand	Deputy Commissioner	Courier Cell
12.	Nitish Pathode	Deputy Commissioner	CCO, MZ-III
13.	Dr. M. Prabhakar	Asstt. Commissioner	ACC (General)

3. The Chief Commissioner of Customs, Mumbai Zone-III welcomed the participants.

4. During the course of Power Point Presentation on the dwell time performance of Air Cargo the fall in dwell time in respect of Customs and other agencies was highlighted for the month of December and January.

DWELL TIME (in Hrs) COMPARISION WITH PGAs (December, 2022)							
Agency Code	**Total BE**	**Inward-Submission**	**Submission-Assessment**	**Assessment-Payment of duty**	**Assessment-Registration**	**Registration-OOC**	**PGA Time (in Hrs.)**
FSSAI	320	-4.74	45.71	67.15	102.36	90.11	**184.66**
ADC	4135	-17.82	16.28	43.15	57.86	21.91	**66.62**
WCCB	109	-26.7	4.39	57.89	87.74	13.03	**26.92**
PQ	227	3.72	11.64	111.33	193.28	115.53	**210.51**
AQ	254	-36.88	95.6	-29.34	86.81	14.37	**85.53**

DWELL TIME (in Hrs) COMPARISION WITH PGAs (January, 2023)							
Agency Code	**Total BE**	**Inward-Submission**	**Submission-Assessment**	**Assessment-Payment of duty**	**Assessment-Registration**	**Registration-OOC**	**PGA Time (in Hrs.)**
FSSAI	270	5.72	19.78	74.62	147.81	71.84	**168.42**
ADC	3594	-3.21	119.73	-116.07	63.28	11.38	**69.42**
WCCB	124	-16.28	574.25	-547.48	88.49	21.84	**43.79**
PQ	206	-21.88	11.23	66.03	205.96	48.34	**203.98**
AQ	217	-3.28	1796.41	-1834.8	86.06	15.85	**107.38**

The Chair noticed that none of PGAs were present during the meeting so that the high dwell time could be discussed. The Chair observed that the whole purpose of CCFC becomes meaningless if the representatives of the other PGAs are not present in the CCFC. The Chair also observed that one of the objective of CCFC is to ensure timely clearance of cargo as required under National Trade Facilitation Action Plan 2022-2023 and has been set up with approval of Cabinet Secretary. Accordingly PGAs should attend the meeting to achieve the NCTF target. The Chair accordingly directed that the fact brought to the notice of the Regional Heads of the concerned agencies by the Commissioner of Customs (General) by means of D.O. letter so that the representatives are available for discussions in the next meeting.

The Chair also observed that the objective of holding CCFC at regular intervals was to understand the issues which affects speedy clearance of Cargo.

He observed that the target given for Air Cargo Complex by National Trade Facilitation Action (NCTF) Plan is 24 hours for clearance of cargo and unless all Government Agencies work together the objective of cost saving for corporate by timely clearance of cargo cannot be achieved. He accordingly observed that necessary steps to request all Participating Government Agencies to be present in CCFC may be taken.

4.1 During the meeting it was highlighted that the Assistant Drug Controller office, although on EDI System, had directed the importers to submit the necessary documents through e-mail. When the issue was pointed out, Mrs. Manita Churi informed that the practice for calling for necessary documents on e-mail is being followed by ADC's office all across the country. The Chair observed that the time taken by ADC during the clearance is calculated in the EDI System when the Bill of Entry is forwarded to the ADC office of EDI, and not when the documents are received by them on mail. At this point Shri Dushyant Mulani, President, BCBA informed that all mandatory documents are uploaded on E-Sanchit for ADC's NOC. It was informed by Mrs. Manita Churi at times it is difficult to download the documents. The Chair observed that the internet connections are similar across the Air Cargo Complex. The Chair observed that EDI runs on leased lines as such there is no difficulty in downloading documents and uploading on E-Sanchit. However, considering the point made by Mrs. Manita Churi he directed Commissioner (General) to write to Director Controller for adoption of uniform practice across the country by means of D.O. Letter.

5. The Chair also discussed high time taken for Payment of Duty after assessment by importers. The matter was highlighted 6th NCTF Meeting held on 25.08.2022 and directed to trade to minimize it. The Chair showed concern over numbers of Bills of Entry sent back to importer after payment of duty, causing dwell time enhancement. Shri Satish Shitole, JC/Import explained there are many reasons like any query raised, importer/CHA was not presence for examination etc. The Chair considered it can be minimized. Thereafter, pending issues from earlier CCFC Meeting held on 15.11.2022 were taken up for discussion: -

Agenda Point – No.1 (Old Agenda Pt. 1)	Reduction of dwell time in clearance of commercial consignments imported through courier mode.
Discussion	In this connection, the Chair in earlier CCFC Meeting held on 15.11.2022 informed that the PN issued in the year 2011 has become redundant in the context of advent of new technology in filing/processing of bill of entry online and customs clearance and hence, suggested that the PN issued in 2011 should be replaced with a new PN taking into account changes and hence the SOP. The Chair was informed that APSC Commissionerate has prepared a PN and will be finalized shortly.

(Action to be taken by: APSC Commissionerate)

Agenda Point – No. 3 (Old Agenda Pt. 3)

Infrastructure developments being created related to the Ongoing construction at Air Cargo Complex, Andheri (East), Mumbai.

Discussion

General Commissionerate informed that MIAL has not submitted design/layout of Import Cargo Terminal-2 till date. It was also informed that main entrance and exit gate at ACC has been completed and same is operational now. Further, Pre-Engineering Building (PEB) work has also been started and the same is verified by them. MIAL has informed General Commissionerate that the work is supposed to be completed by the end of February, 2024.

The Chair was informed by the MIAL that Infrastructural developments were pending only at Import Cargo Terminal-2 and will be completed within the stipulated time-frame.

The Chair asked why design/layout of Import Cargo Terminal-2 not submitted by MIAL till date whereas they have also committed in the earlier CCFC Meeting held on 15.11.2022. The MIAL informed the Chair that they will submit the same to General Commissionerate very soon.

(Action to be taken by MIAL & The Commissioner of Customs (General), ACC, Mumbai)

New Agenda Point No. 1

E-Office Issues: Trade is facing significant challenges in the clearance of import and export consignments, particularly when processed through E-Office:

a) The processing of routine amendment files through E-Office is extremely time-consuming.
b) The frequent processing of partial shipments and short shipment amendments through ACC adds to the complexity.
c) There is also a parallel manual process in place.
d) Inadequate internet connectivity to access E-Office.
e) The lack of scanners for uploading documents in E-Office.

Discussion:-

(i) Shri Dushyant Mulani, President BCBA, informed that processing of routine amendment files through E-Office is extremely time-consuming therefore he suggested that processing of routine amendment files through E-Office should be dis-continued. The Chair informed that e-office brings about transparency and speed in work and it is preferable to keep records on E-office. It was informed that mostly E-files are opened at TA level. Hence, TAs are posted in some Group to just open E-Office file and also observed that whenever there is any query raised file is processed at lower level.

The Chair directed that file must be opened at examiner level or above, even JC/ADC can also open a file and raised query

can be resolved at any level. Further, in case the Examining Officer is not available, the file should be opened by the next level of senior officer. All out efforts must be made to complete the amendment process pertaining to live Bills of Entry within 3 hours of receipts of such request. Steps to be taken to ensure that decision of E-Office should be taken in lesser or equal time to manual process timing.

(ii) Shri Dushyant Mulani, President BCBA, further informed that a physical file can be referred/quoted for future reference regarding any related to CTH Classification whereas such facility is not available in E-office. Commissioner General said that E-file can also be referred for future reference and suggested that E-file number should be noted down by trade.

(iii) Shri Dushyant Mulani, President BCBA, also informed that trade cannot trace/locate current status of the E-office file.

It was decided that if required, EMD Manager help should be taken for the reference by the concerned section.

(Action to be taken by The Commissioner of Customs (Import), ACC, Mumbai)

Meeting ended with a vote-of-thanks to the Chair.

24/3/2023

(Rajiv Shankar)
Additional Commissioner
CCO/Zone-III

Copy to:

1. The Under Secretary, (Cus. IV), CBIC, North Block, New Delhi.
2. All Pr. Commissioner/Commissioner of Customs, Mumbai Zone-III
3. All the Members of CCFC (Through e-mail)
4. The DC/EDI, ACC (with a request to upload the minutes on the Zonal website)

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